

Juan Pablo Durango Cardona

(Juan-P. Durango; Juan P. Durango; Durango J.P.; Cardona J.P.D.)

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Professional profile

Biologist from Universidad EAFIT with experience in taxonomy, natural history, and conservation of Neotropical amphibians and reptiles, especially anurans from Colombia. My research focuses on anuran bioacoustics and its applications in taxonomy and systematics. I have worked in environmental consulting performing fauna inventories for biodiversity offsetting and environmental impact assessment. I have experience working with biological collections, laboratory techniques, and species identification using third and new generation sequencing. I have conducted fieldwork in high-diversity, poorly explored, and difficult-to-access areas, complemented with science communication in local communities for nature conservation.

Education

Universidad EAFIT
B.Sc. in Biology

Medellín, Antioquia, Colombia
06/2016 – 04/2024

Scholarships & Awards

Ser Pilo Paga
Government of Colombia

11/2015

- Conditional loan program to finance university degrees in accredited high-quality institutions for the country's best low-income students.

Mini Grant Program
EvoBio Crash Course

12/2024
~206.88 USD

- Support to overcome a tangible barrier when applying for or accessing the next stage of training in evolutionary biology.

Skills

Hard skills

- **Languages** : Spanish (Native), English (C1 - IELTS), Portuguese (A1) and German (A1)
- **Molecular** : DNA extraction, amplification (PCR), quantification and sequencing (Oxford Nanopore).
- **Field** : Pitfall traps, auditory band transects, linear transects, acoustic monitoring. Snake handling and relocation.

Computational skills

- **Bioinformatics** : Geneious, Garli, BEAST
- **Office** : Microsoft Office (Word, Excel, PowerPoint), LibreOffice
- **Creative** : Gimp, Adobe Premiere, Adobe Lightroom, Adobe Photoshop
- **Programming** : R, Matlab, Python, shell scripting (Linux/Unix), LATEX,
- **Others** : Raven, Audacity, ArcGIS, QGIS, MaxENT

Research experience

Sustainability and Systems Area, Universidad EAFIT
Position: *Young researcher*

08/01/2024 – 07/31/2025
Medellín, Antioquia, Colombia

Project: DNA barcoding of small mammals from Colombia, using **Oxford Nanopore Technologies** sequencing.

Supervisor: Juan Fernando Diaz Nieto

Experience

- Biological technical consultancy** 03/2026 – 04/2026
eQual SAS On-site – Chinú, Córdoba, Colombia
- **Characterization and baseline of the amphibian and reptile community** in the area of influence for the Environmental Impact Study of an electrical substation.
- Biological technical consultancy** 01/2026 – 02/2026
CGA SAS On-site – Arauca, Arauca, Colombia
- **Characterization of the amphibian and reptile community** of an airport, aimed at updating its environmental management plan for modernization and expansion.
- Biological technical consultancy** 11/21/2025 – 01/31/2026
Universidad EAFIT On-site – Segovia, Antioquia, Colombia
- **Characterization of the amphibian and reptile community** on private lands, for registration as a Civil Society Natural Reserve.
- Biological technical consultancy** 07/2025 – 08/2025
INGEOVITAL ESTUDIOS AMBIENTALES S.A.S. On-site – Remedios/Segovia, Antioquia, Colombia
- **Characterization of the amphibian and reptile community** of a mining project, aimed at biodiversity offsetting.
- Biological technical consultancy** 08/01/2025 – 08/31/2025
Universidad EAFIT On-site – Medellín, Antioquia, Colombia
- Preparation of the glossary, bibliography, and tables for the book **Guide to herps of the Colombian Pacific**.
- Young researcher** 08/01/2024 – 07/31/2025
Universidad EAFIT On-site – Medellín, Antioquia, Colombia
- DNA extraction, amplification (PCR), quantification and sequencing with **Oxford Nanopore Technologies** of small mammals, plants, and amphibians.
 - Consolidation of the Network of territorial spaces and actors of the Museum of Natural and Cultural History of Colombia, at the national level. Partner institutions: Jardín Botánico "Guillermo Piñeres" Foundation, Universidad de los Andes, Alexander von Humboldt Biological Resources Research Institute, International Center for Tropical Agriculture - CIAT, Amazonian Scientific Research Institute - SINCHI, Universidad Pontificia Bolivariana, Universidad EAFIT.
- Biological technical consultancy** 03/2025 – 03/2025
+ Verde S.A.S. BIC On-site – San Cayetano, Norte de Santander, Colombia
- **Characterization of the amphibian and reptile community** in an environmental impact study for environmental licensing procedures.
- Biological technical consultancy** 12/2024 – 12/2024
Marine & Port Consultants S.A.S. On-site – Guapi, Cauca, Colombia
- **Capture and relocation of fauna**, for the demobilization of an infrastructure project.
- Biological technical consultancy** 07/2024 – 08/2024
CONSGA S.A.S. On-site – Palestina, Santander, Colombia
- **Characterization of the amphibian and reptile community** of an infrastructure project, aimed at biodiversity offsetting.
- Biological technical consultancy** 01/2024 – 02/2024
INGEOVITAL ESTUDIOS AMBIENTALES S.A.S. On-site – Remedios, Antioquia, Colombia
- **Characterization of the amphibian and reptile community** of a mining project, aimed at biodiversity offsetting.
- Biological technical consultancy** 11/15/2023 – 11/30/2023
Universidad EAFIT On-site – Tamesis, Antioquia, Colombia
- Research assistant for mammal monitoring of the **Habitat Bank in Antioquia El Globo cloud forest**.
- Biological technical consultancy** 03/2023 – 04/2023
INGEOVITAL ESTUDIOS AMBIENTALES S.A.S. On-site – Segovia, Antioquia, Colombia
- **Characterization of the amphibian and reptile community** of a mining project, aimed at biodiversity offsetting.

Educational internships

De Costa a Costa

06/2022 – 11/2022

On-site – Bahía Solano, Chocó, Colombia

- **Educational internships** in ecotourism with an emphasis on whale watching.
- **Guided walks** along trails with nature interpretation with emphasis on **Amphibians and Reptiles**.
- **Basic inventory of Fauna and Flora** of the facilities and trails.

Biological technical consultancy

CyC CONSULTORES AMBIENTALES S.A.S.

09/2022 – 09/2022

Remote – Medellín, Antioquia, Colombia

- Specialized service of **bat acoustic data analysis**, aimed at environmental management plans.

Biological technical consultancy

Universidad EAFIT

04/18/2022 – 04/30/2022

On-site – Medellín, Antioquia, Colombia

- **DNA extraction** from cacao seeds for metagenomic analysis.

Biological technical consultancy

INSTITUTO TECNOLÓGICO METROPOLITANO - ITM

07/09/2021 – 12/31/2021

Remote – Medellín, Antioquia, Colombia

- Specialized service of **bat acoustic data analysis**, aimed at environmental management plans.

Biological technical consultancy

Universidad EAFIT

03/01/2021 – 03/31/2021

On-site – Amalfi, Antioquia, Colombia

- **Characterization of the amphibian and reptile community**, aimed at establishing conservation areas.

Educational services provision

INSTITUTO TECNOLÓGICO METROPOLITANO - ITM

09/05/2019 – 03/18/2021

On-site – Medellín, Antioquia, Colombia

- Support the design of services and public engagement of the educational internship program of the La Salle Natural Sciences Museum Science Center.

Academic monitoring

STEP Project

02/2020 – 03/2020

On-site – Bahía Solano, Chocó, Colombia

- Field assistant in the **characterization of herpetofauna** of a community in the Colombian Chocó, aimed at developing scientific tourism in the area.

Academic monitoring

Clubes de Ciencia Colombia

06/18/2018 – 06/23/2018

On-site – Medellín, Antioquia, Colombia

- Support in the development of laboratory activities, advising high school students.

Publications (†principal author, ‡equal contribution, §secondary contribution)

Citations (Google scholar)

June 2026

Total [5] | h-index [1]

Published

9. Durango, J.P.[†] & Arredondo, J.C. (2026). On the type locality of *Andinobates opisthomelas* (Boulenger, 1899) and *Colostethus pratti* (Boulenger, 1899), with a redescription of *A. opisthomelas* based on newly collected topotypes. *South American Journal of Herpetology*, 38(1): 45–60. <https://doi.org/10.2994/SAJH-D-24-00004.1>
8. Garzón-Franco, E., Durango, J.P.[‡] & Arredondo, J.C. (2026). Predation of the Chocoan robber frog, *Strabomantis anomalus* (Strabomantidae), by a Cat-eyed snake, *Leptodeira ornata* (Dipsadidae) in the Colombian Chocó. *Revista Latinoamericana De Herpetología*, 9(1), e1388: 173–176. <https://doi.org/10.22201/fc.25942158e.2026.1.1388>
7. Lozano-Arias, J.M., Gómez-Mesa, L., Durango, J.P.[‡], & Garzón-Franco, E. (2026). Hidden in the leaf litter: rediscovery and morphological variation of the largescale lizard, *Alopoglossus grandisquamatus* (Rueda, 1985) (Squamata: Alopoglossidae). *Zootaxa*, 5757(4): 369–381. <https://doi.org/10.11646/zootaxa.5757.4.5>
6. Garzón-Franco, E., Durango, J.P.[‡], Ospina-Sarria, J.J. & Arredondo, J.C. (2026). A new species of *Pristimantis* (Anura: Strabomantidae) from the western slope of the Serranía del Baudó, Chocó, Colombia. *Zootaxa*, 5757(4): 301–323. <https://doi.org/10.11646/zootaxa.5757.4.1>
5. Vargas-Ramirez, Y.C., Garzón-Franco, E., & Durango, J.P.[‡] (2025). New distributional records of the endemic rainfrog *Pristimantis blasi* Duarte-Marín, Montoya-Marín & Rivera-Gómez (Anura, Strabomantidae), towards the Chocó of Colombia. *Revista Latinoamericana De Herpetología*, 8(1), e1114: 143–147. <https://doi.org/10.22201/fc.25942158e.2025.1.1114>

4. **Durango, J.P.[†] (2025).** The Advertisement Call of the Santa Marta robber frog *Serranobatrachus sanctaemartae* (Ruthven 1917). *The Herpetological Bulletin*, 171: 30–32. <https://doi.org/10.33256/hb171.3032>
3. **Durango, J.P.[†] (2024).** The Distress Call of *Smilisca phaeota* (Cope 1862) (Hylidae: Hylinae) during manipulation. *Reptiles & Amphibians*, 31: e2186. <https://doi.org/10.17161/randa.v31i1.21860>
2. **Durango, J.P.,[†] Garzón-Franco, E., Gómez-Mesa, L., Lozano-Arias, J.M., Guayasamin, J.M. & Arredondo, J.C. (2024).** Geographic call variation in the Granular Glassfrog *Cochranella granulosa* (Taylor, 1949) (Anura, Centrolenidae) and a new distribution record in Colombia. *Herpetology Notes*, 17: 587–595. <https://www.biotaxa.org/hn/article/view/85050>
1. **Durango, J.P.[†], Garzón-Franco, E., Castellanos-Mejía, M.C. & Arredondo, J.C. (2022).** Predation by a Cope's False Coralsnake, *Pliocercus euryzonus* (Cope 1862) (Dipsadidae), on a catfish (Trichomycteridae: *Trichomycterus*) in the northern Andes of Colombia. *Reptiles & Amphibians*, 29: 95–97. <https://doi.org/10.17161/randa.v29i1.16256>

In preparation

- **Durango, J.P. & Arredondo, J.C. (In prep).** Advertisement call, tadpole morphology and other natural history notes of *Leucostethus dysprosium* (Rivero and Serna, 2000).
- **Durango, J.P. & Grant, T. (In prep).** The systematics of *Colostethus pratti* (Anura, Dendrobatoidea).
- Garzón-Franco, E., **Durango, J.P.**, Vargas-Ramírez, Y.C., & Lozano-Arias, J.M. (In prep). A new species related to *Pristimantis labiosus* (Anura, Craugastoridae), from Chocó, Colombia.

Peer-reviewer work

- The Herpetological Bulletin, UK

Conferences, fairs and meetings

IV Colombian Congress of Herpetology

Universidad del Magdalena

12/01/2025 – 12/06/2025

On-site – Santa Marta, Magdalena, Colombia

- **Oral presentation:** Delimitation and redescription of *Andinobates opisthomelas* (Boulenger, 1899).
- **Oral presentation:** Larval development and additional natural history notes of *Leucostethus dysprosium* (Dendrobatoidea: Colostethinae).
- **Poster:** Local science: importance of a local vision in the systematics of the *Colostethus pratti* complex.

II Colombian Congress of Bioacoustics and Ecoacoustics

Parque Explora

11/18/2024 – 11/22/2024

On-site – Medellín, Antioquia, Colombia

- **Organizing assistant**

III Colombian Congress of Herpetology

Universidad ICESI

07/31/2022 – 08/05/2022

On-site – Cali, Valle del Cauca, Colombia

- **Oral presentation:** Clarification of the type locality of *Andinobates opisthomelas* and *Colostethus pratti* with comments on the taxonomic identity of *A. opisthomelas*

XVI Departmental Meeting of Research Seedbeds

Universidad de Antioquia

05/18/2017 – 05/20/2017

On-site – Medellín, Antioquia, Colombia

- **Poster**

XVII Departmental Meeting of Research Seedbeds

Institución Universitaria de Envigado

05/09/2018 – 05/11/2018

On-site – Medellín, Antioquia, Colombia

- **Poster**

Research Seedbeds Fair

Universidad EAFIT

10/04/2018 – 10/05/2018

On-site – Medellín, Antioquia, Colombia

- **Poster**

Research groups and seedbeds

Biodiversity Research Seedbed

School of Applied Sciences and Engineering, Universidad EAFIT

06/2018 – Present

Reinventing Research Seedbed

La Salle Natural Sciences Museum - ITM

06/2018 – Present

References

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